HER GAME PLAN
The Women Playmakers' Network

UX/UI CASE STUDY · DESIGN TO BUILD

from figma prototype to a working app.

Katie Rygiel · research, UX/UI, brand and build



figma mockup

live app

the project

Her Game Plan is a networking app for women working in sports: set goals with community support, find mentors, share wins, and get career resources in one place.

It started as my senior honors project at Ramapo College, designed in Figma. I've since rebuilt it as a working web app that runs on iPhone and desktop.

ROLE

Research, UX/UI design, brand identity, product

TOOLS

Figma, InDesign, React, Supabase

PROCESS

Interviews, personas, competitor analysis, lo-fi to hi-fi

STATUS

Live web app, getting ready for user testing

the problem

Women are underrepresented across the sports industry, especially in coaching and leadership, and the networks that build careers weren't built with them in mind.

career development

Connections and mentors open doors, but the right opportunities are hard to reach.

industry challenges

Unequal pay, few women in leadership, and pressure to prove yourself twice over.

growth and support

Community and mentors build confidence, resilience and better career decisions.

Themes from my interviews with women working in and studying sports, plus secondary research

WHAT I HEARD

“I try to network as much as I can but I don't really know how it works or what to do.”

Interview participant, student-athlete

who it's for

THE ESTABLISHED PRO

Sarah, 29

Sports marketing manager, Chicago

Wants mentorship from women in leadership and peers to collaborate with.

THE COACH

Maria, 35

Head coach, women's basketball, LA

Often one of few women in senior coaching; wants others who get it.

THE ASPIRING PRO

Emma, 22

Student-athlete and design major, Denver

Needs a path from college athletics into a sports design career.

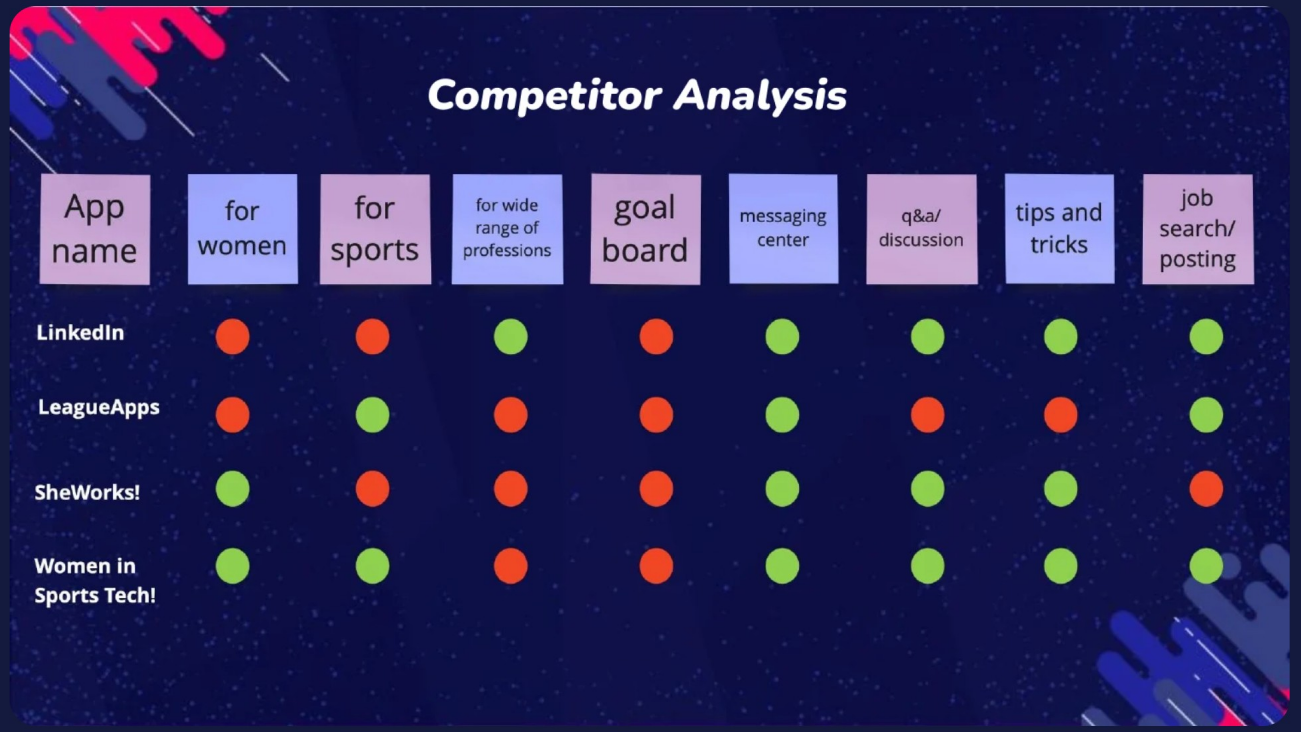
THE VETERAN MENTOR

Carla, 47

Social media director, New York

Wants to give back by mentoring the next generation of women.

Emma became the primary persona for the prototype. She's who you meet on the home screen.



finding the gap

LinkedIn, LeagueApps, SheWorks! and Women in Sports Tech each cover part of this. None is built for every woman across the sports industry, and none has a goal board.

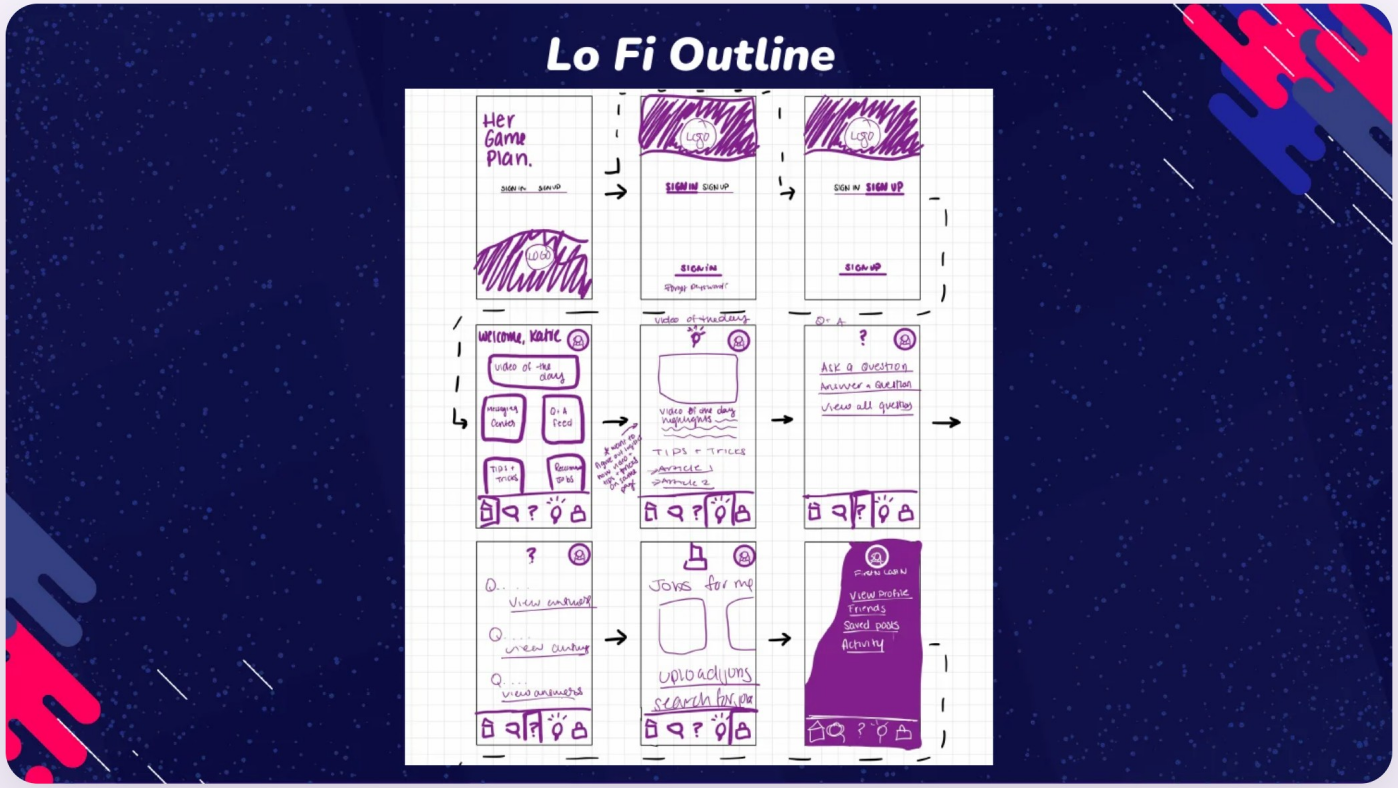
THE DIFFERENTIATOR

A goal board where members set goals, cheer each other on, and give advice to those a step behind.

STEP 1 · SKETCH

mapping the flow on paper

Lo-fi sketches mapped every path first: sign in, home, video of the day, Q&A, jobs and profile, all tied to one bottom nav.



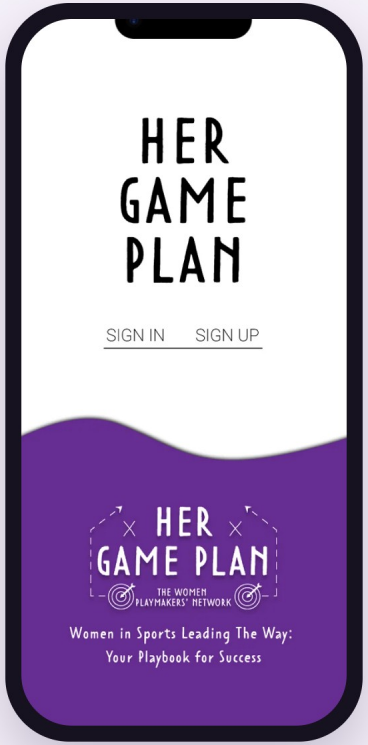
STEP 2 · DESIGN

high-fidelity mockups in figma

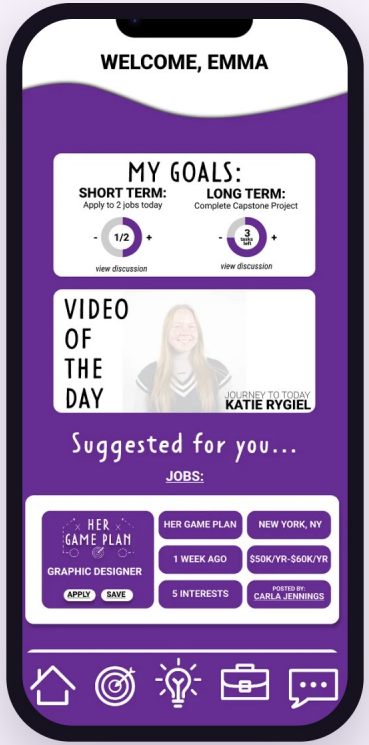
Bold purple, wave dividers and big progress rings gave the app a sporty, confident feel. One icon bar ties it together: home, goals, tips, jobs, connect.



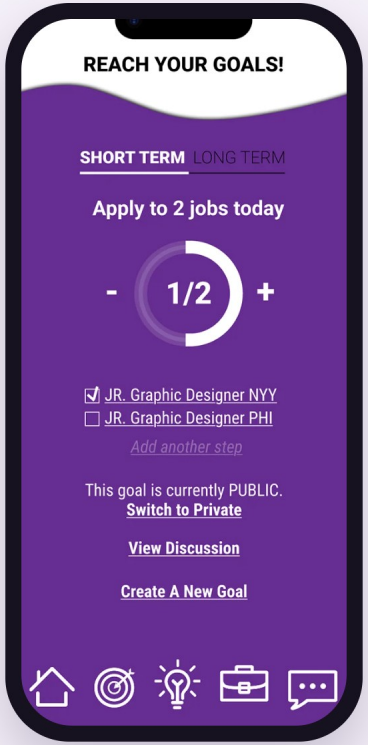
the prototype: the core loop



1 · welcome. Sign in or sign up, with the brand front and center.



2 · home. Goals at a glance, video of the day, suggested jobs.



3 · goals. Track progress, add steps, make it public or private.

STEP 3 · BUILD

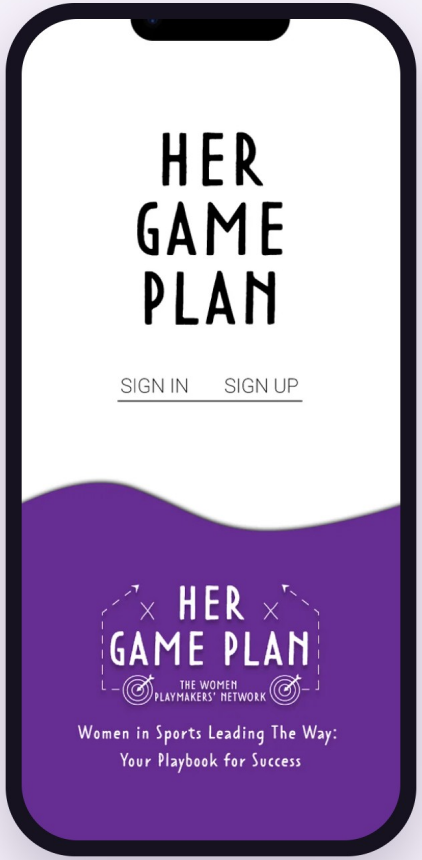
then I made it real.

I turned the Figma prototype into a working web app that runs on iPhone and desktop. I built it with Claude as my coding partner, and my HTML and CSS basics let me read the code and make adjustments myself while I led the design and product decisions.

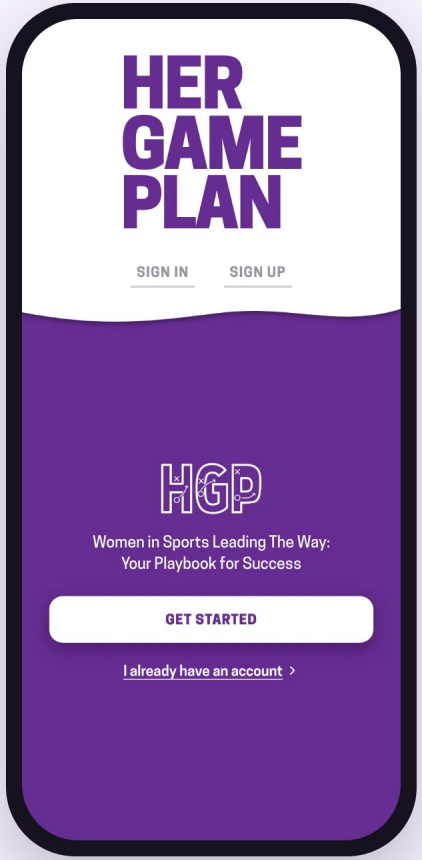
DESIGN → BUILD · WELCOME

same first impression, sharper brand

- Swapped in the refreshed HGP logo and Cooper Hewitt type from the updated brand
- Kept the white-to-purple wave as the signature divider
- Clear "Get started" and "I already have an account" paths for new and returning members



figma prototype

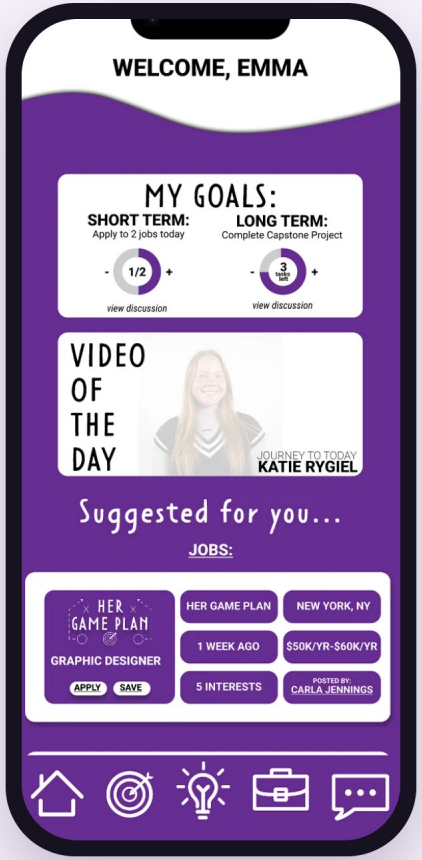


live app

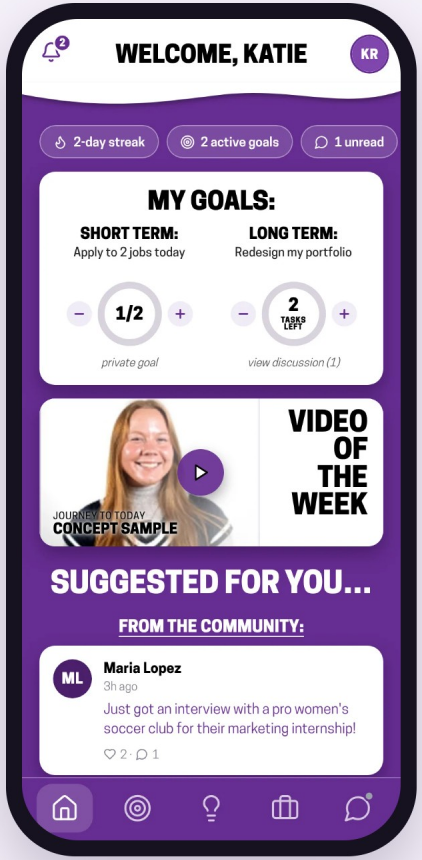
DESIGN → BUILD · HOME

the dashboard, now working

- Streak, active goals and unread chips show status at a glance
- Goal rings are live: tap + or – and progress saves instantly
- "Suggested for you" now surfaces real posts from the community
- Video of the week, clearly labeled as a concept sample



figma prototype

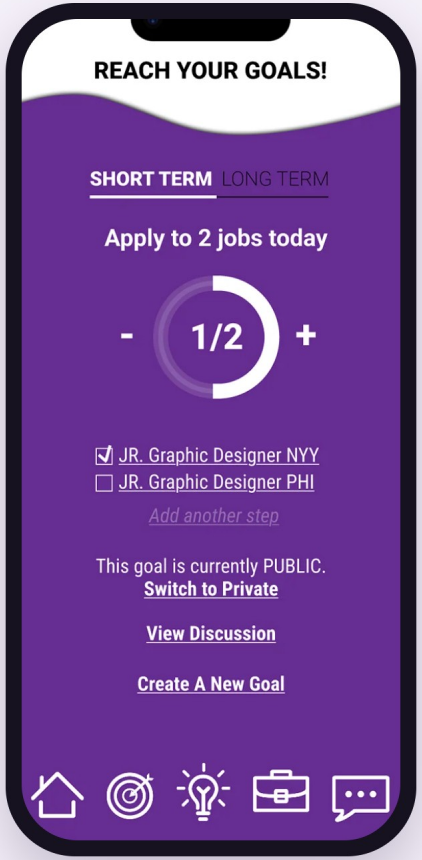


live app

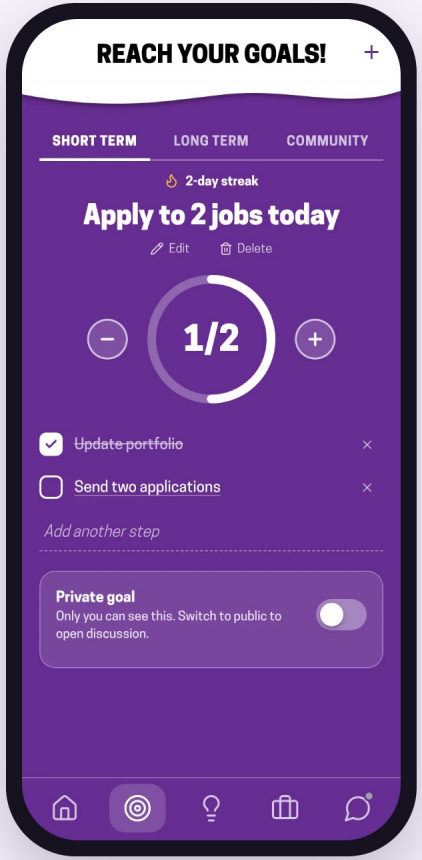
DESIGN → BUILD · GOALS

the goal board, fully built

- Kept the big progress ring and step checklist from the prototype
- Edit and delete on every goal
- A private toggle replaced the "switch to private" link
- New Community tab to see and cheer on others' goals

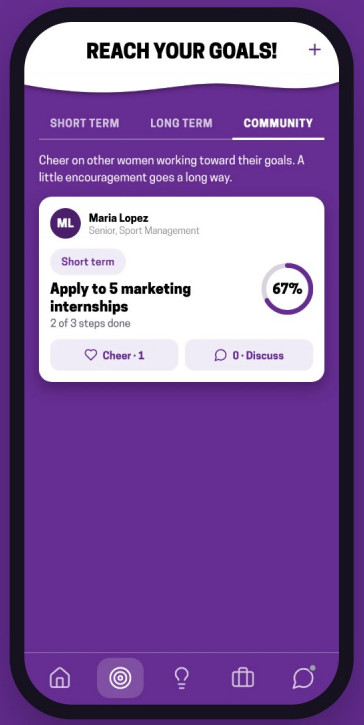


figma prototype

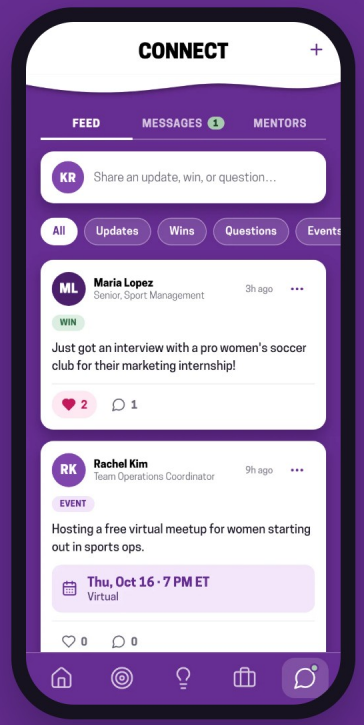


live app

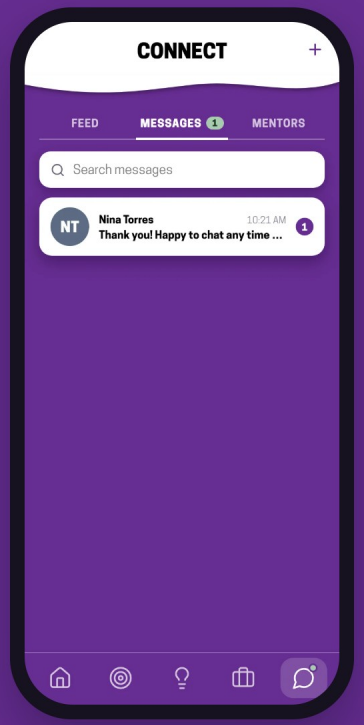
beyond the prototype



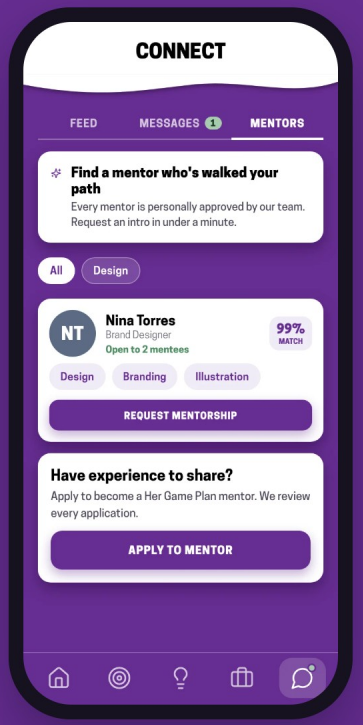
community goals: cheer each other on



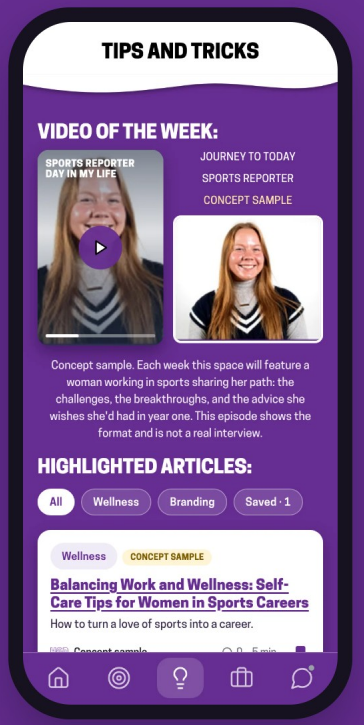
feed: wins, questions and events



messages: real-time, one-to-one



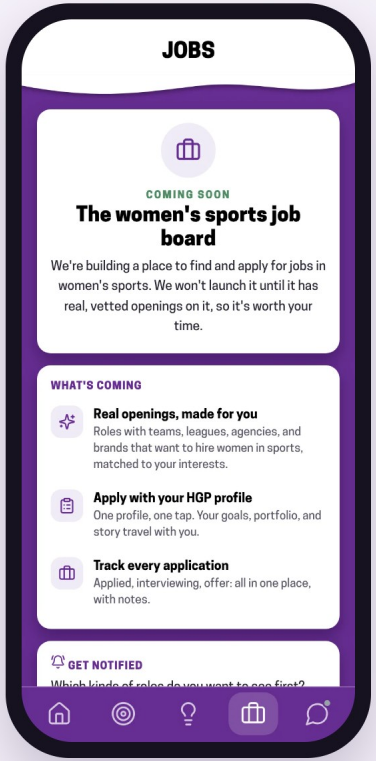
mentors: matched by interests



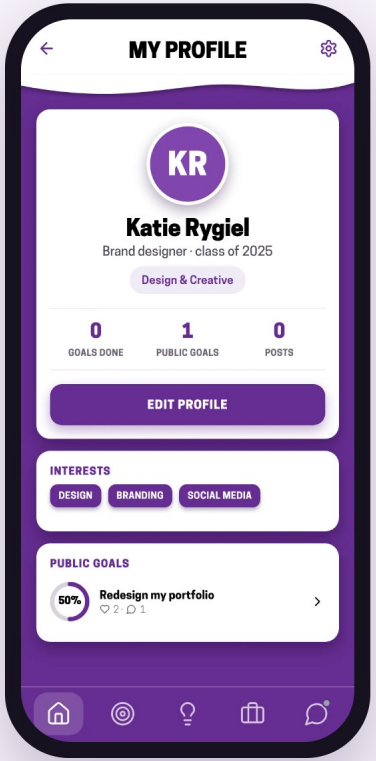
tips: career advice from the field

designed to launch, not just to demo

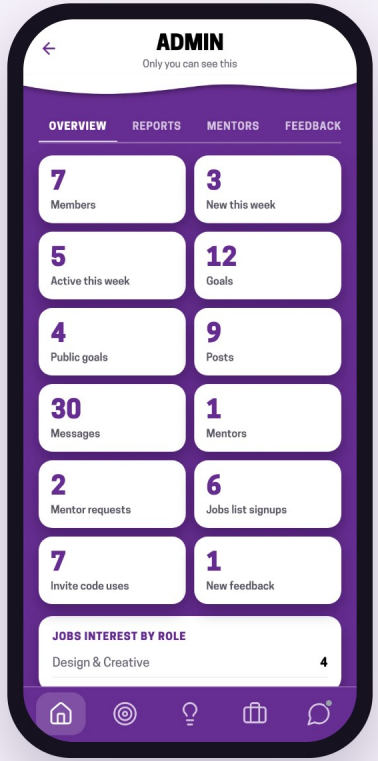
Building it forced decisions a prototype never asks: who can become a mentor, what happens before the job board has listings, and who keeps the community safe.



jobs "coming soon" collects interest first



profiles that carry your story



admin approves every mentor

under the hood

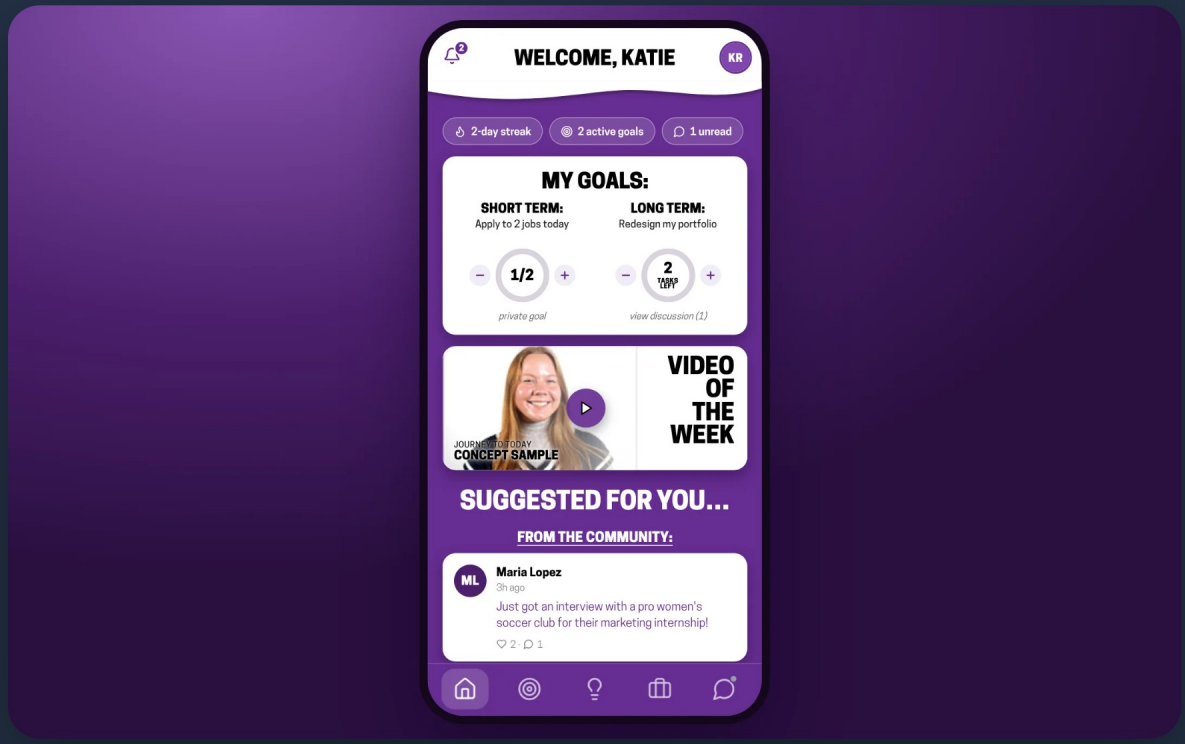
React + Vite: mobile-first, works on iPhone and desktop, installable to the home screen

Supabase: accounts, a real database and live updates

Privacy by design: private goals stay private, messages are visible only to the two people in them

Member control: export or delete your own data anytime

Tested: 25 automated UI tests



one brand on every screen

The app uses the same system as the rest of the brand: Cooper Hewitt type, soft lowercase headlines, and the four core colors.

blitz roster tennis bleacher



what I learned, and what's next

LEARNED

A prototype shows the happy path. Building it surfaced everything around it: empty states, privacy, moderation and admin tools.

Designing with real constraints made the product more honest, from labeling concept content to launching jobs as "coming soon."

NEXT

01 Test with a small group on desktop and iPhone

02 Gauge traction and refine from feedback

03 Develop it into a native App Store app



she's rewriting the playbook.

Katie Rygiel · katierygiel.github.io/portfolio · katierygiel@comcast.net